

Training and Visit system of Extension

Training and Visit System

Re-organised extension system

With the introduction of programmes like community development, subsequent support and participation of the people in such development programmes, peoples' expectations started raising.

There was not enough trained people to address the elevated expectations of the society. At the same time there was regular addition into technological inputs.

Key features of Training and Visit System

1. Professionalism: The key input is information input

Only those people trained in agricultural sciences are the part

When we have homogeneous academic background in personnel, it makes them more professional

2. Single line of command: Extension services are just like conglomerates, various units are essential and each has its role to play

- There should not be administrative dichotomy for the personnel
- The unit which is giving administrative control should have technical control also
- A perfect subordinate and superordinate relationship

3. Concentration of efforts: as it was evidenced in other programmes and approaches including community development programme, the extension professional should not be overloaded with other activities other than agriculture services.

4. Time bound work:

If you miss the time, you will miss season, if you miss the season, you miss the economy.

There are works spelled based on time.

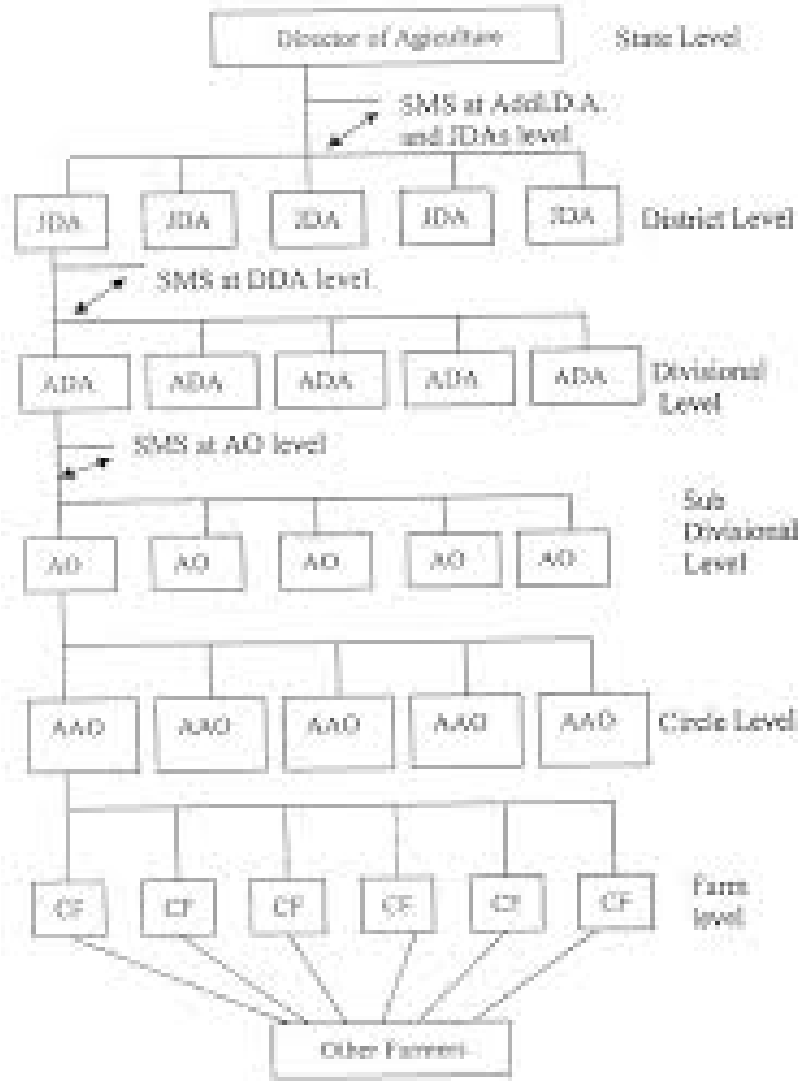
Every village level worker will have to visit the pre-decided villages and establish linkage with contact farmers.

5. Field and Farmer orientation: It is envisaged that there should be strong linkages between extension workers, farmers and research system. Without having field and farmer orientation it cannot be achieved. Regular face to face interaction is very essential in an efficient extension system.

6. Regular and continuous training: Field level extension workers have perfect 14 day cycle for visits to their allotted villages and on 15th day of every month they need to report to their higher ups for training. And the cycle continues.

7. Linkages with research: effective research depends on linkages with extension and vice-versa. Extension and research are interdependent. Efficient linkages provide a definite relationship to the linkages. Both these systems cannot find their existence without each other.

Organisational Pattern of the T & V System of
Agricultural Extension



Limitations of T and V System

- Staff intensive and suffered in places where adequate staff not in position.
- Except crop production, other enterprises remained untouched
- In states having separate directorate of Horticulture, Soil conservation etc flow of information to farmers in these areas was scanty.
- Information flow to farmers was of routine type
- Emphasis was on technology and very little on extension methods, management techniques
- Except 'personal contact' method of extension methods and aids were not put into practice
- The existing village leaders and village institutions were neglected.
- Lack of adequate interaction between contact farmers and other farmers.

United Nations Development Programme (1990) enlisted weakness as reported by G. L. Ray

- Limited use of mass media hindering the effectiveness, specially in reaching women and other small scale farmers.
- Limited or no clientele involvement in programme development.
- Recurrent cost problems that becomes serious when donor funding terminates.
- Weak links with research, lack of adequate subject matter specialist capacity, frequently resulting in the lack of appropriate technology.

World Bank (1990) recommendations which are applicable to India

1. Agricultural Extension requires effective organization and management tailored to suit the specific situations. This recommendation respects the location specificity of need of information based on cropping and farming systems in the specific region.
2. Agricultural Extension requires site specific methodologies and suitable technologies. The implication of the recommendation is research as well as extension both are to be situation specific. We cannot have the blanket recommendation for the state or any region.
3. Agricultural Extension must be relevant and responsive. There should be two way communication between all the three elements of agricultural research and extension system. Strong linkage between research-extension and farmer.
4. Farmer participation is fundamental to sustainable extension. Hence we observe the approaches adopted in the post 1990s include participatory approaches invariably. It may be participatory varietal development, participatory technology development, etc.

Conclusion

Extension is a continuous process, change is inevitable in extension methodologies, but the process remain same. Looking into the technological advancement, needs of the people, ability to access technologies, skill in accessing the technologies etc factors extension will be modifying its mode of delivery for the target communities.